



Lecture 04: Emotion and Motivation — Complete Study Notes



Part 1: Emotion

1. Definition of Emotion

Emotions are **complex psychological states** that involve three distinct components:

1. **Physiological arousal** – changes in the body (heart rate, hormones, sweating, etc.)
2. **Expressive behaviors** – outward signs of emotions (facial expressions, gestures, tone of voice)
3. **Conscious experience** – the internal, subjective feeling of the emotion (how you “feel” inside)



In simple terms:

Emotion = a biologically-based, learned, and personally relevant reaction involving both body and mind.

Example:

When you see a snake:

- Your heart rate increases (physiological response)
 - You scream or jump back (expressive behavior)
 - You feel fear (subjective experience)
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2. Characteristics of Emotions

- **Biological basis:** Emotions are linked to brain structures (like the amygdala and hypothalamus).
 - **Personal relevance:** Triggered by situations important to the individual.
 - **Automatic and immediate:** Often occur instantly, before conscious thought.
 - **Shaped by learning:** Experience and culture influence how we interpret and express emotions.
 - **Adaptive value:** Emotions help humans survive by guiding behavior.
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3. Components of Emotion

Component	Description	Example
Physiological	Body's response (autonomic nervous system activation)	Heart pounding, sweating when afraid
Behavioral	Expressive behavior or action	Smiling, frowning, crying
Cognitive	Thoughts, labels, and interpretation	"This situation is dangerous" → fear

4. Early Displays of Emotion (Infants)

- Even newborns display **basic emotional expressions**, showing that emotions are **innate**.
- Basic emotions appear within the first few months:
 - Joy → smiling
 - Anger → crying or screaming
 - Disgust → wrinkled nose
 - Fear → startled reflex
 - Sadness → whimpering, tears

 **Conclusion:** Emotional responses are biologically programmed rather than learned through experience.

5. Emotions Across Cultures

- **Universality:** Research by *Paul Ekman* shows that facial expressions for six basic emotions are recognized across all human cultures.
 - **Cultural variations:**
 - While emotions are universal, the **rules for expressing** them (called *display rules*) differ.
 - Example:
 - In Japan, people hide anger in public to maintain harmony.
 - In Western cultures, people express emotions more openly.
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6. Six Basic Emotions (Paul Ekman)

Psychologist **Paul Ekman** identified six emotions that are **innate and universal**:

Emotion	Description	Facial Expression Example
Happiness	Feeling pleasure and satisfaction	Smiling, relaxed muscles
Sadness	Feeling loss or disappointment	Drooping eyelids, tears
Fear	Perceiving threat or danger	Wide eyes, tense body
Disgust	Feeling repulsion or aversion	Wrinkled nose, pursed lips
Anger	Response to threat or injustice	Frowning, clenched jaw
Surprise	Reaction to unexpected events	Raised eyebrows, open mouth

✅ These emotions are considered the foundation for more **complex emotions** like jealousy, pride, guilt, and shame.

7. Emotion vs. Mood

Aspect	Emotion	Mood
Duration	Short-term (seconds to minutes)	Long-term (hours to days)
Cause	Specific trigger	Often unclear or general

Aspect	Emotion	Mood
Intensity	Strong and focused	Milder and diffuse
Example	Feeling angry after insult	Feeling irritable all day

Example:

You might feel **anger (emotion)** after losing a game, but that may turn into a **bad mood** lasting the whole evening.

8. Functions of Emotions

Emotions are **essential for human functioning** and serve three main purposes:

1. Prepare us for action:

- Emotions trigger physiological responses that ready the body for response.
- Example: Fear → “fight or flight” → increases heart rate and alertness.

2. Shape future behavior:

- Emotional experiences help in **learning**.
- Example: Fear of failure motivates you to study harder next time.

3. Help in social interactions:

- Emotions communicate our feelings to others and promote bonding.
 - Example: A smile signals friendliness and approachability.
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9. Biological Basis of Emotion

- **Amygdala:** Central in fear and aggression.
 - **Hypothalamus:** Regulates physiological responses to emotion (e.g., sweating, heart rate).
 - **Prefrontal cortex:** Controls emotion regulation and decision-making.
 - **Autonomic Nervous System (ANS):** Produces changes in body state (sympathetic = arousal; parasympathetic = calm).
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Part 2: Motivation

1. Definition of Motivation

Motivation is the **internal process** that initiates, guides, and maintains goal-directed behavior.

It is what **causes us to act** — whether to eat, study, exercise, or pursue dreams.

Key elements of motivation:

1. **Activation** – deciding to take action.
2. **Persistence** – continuing effort despite obstacles.
3. **Intensity** – the amount of focus and energy applied.

2. Types of Motivation

Type	Description	Example
Intrinsic Motivation	Driven by internal satisfaction or interest.	Studying because you love learning.
Extrinsic Motivation	Driven by external rewards or avoiding punishment.	Studying to get good grades or avoid scolding.

 Intrinsic motivation usually leads to **long-term satisfaction** and creativity.

3. Theories of Motivation

A. Instinct Theory (Evolutionary Perspective)

- Proposed by **William McDougall** and influenced by **Charles Darwin**.
- States that **behaviors are driven by instincts**, which are **inborn biological tendencies** that help survival.

- Humans have instincts like curiosity, parental care, and social belonging.

Limitation:

- Cannot explain learned or complex behaviors like career choice or studying for exams.

Example:

- A newborn's rooting reflex to find milk is instinctive.
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B. Drive-Reduction Theory (Clark Hull)

- Based on the principle of **homeostasis** (balance).
- When a biological need (e.g., hunger, thirst, sleep) is unmet, it creates an **internal drive**.
- This drive **motivates** behavior to reduce tension and restore balance.

Process:

1. **Need:** Water
2. **Drive:** Thirst
3. **Behavior:** Drinking
4. **Homeostasis:** Restored balance

Limitation:

- Cannot explain behavior that increases tension (e.g., thrill-seeking, fasting).
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C. Arousal Theory

- People seek to maintain an **optimal level of arousal** — neither too low nor too high.
- Too little arousal → boredom
- Too much arousal → stress

- Moderate arousal → peak performance (known as the *Yerkes-Dodson Law*)

Example:

- A student performs best in exams when slightly nervous (optimal arousal).
- Too calm → lazy; too stressed → forgetful.

D. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

- Proposed by **Abraham Maslow (1943)**.
- Suggests human needs are **arranged in a hierarchy** from basic to advanced.
- Lower needs must be met **before** higher ones become motivating.

Maslow's 5 Levels of Needs

Level	Need Type	Description	Examples
1 Physiological	Basic biological needs	Air, food, water, sleep, sex, shelter	Eating, sleeping
2 Safety	Security, stability	Protection from harm, job security, health	Safe home, stable income
3 Love & Belongingness	Social relationships	Friendship, intimacy, family, group belonging	Making friends, being loved
4 Esteem	Respect and achievement	Self-respect, recognition, confidence	Getting awards, success
5 Self-Actualization	Personal growth	Realizing potential, creativity, fulfillment	Becoming an artist, helping others

Key idea:

You cannot focus on higher needs (esteem/self-actualization) if lower needs (food/safety) are unmet.

Example:

A starving person will not care about fame until they find food.

4. Applying Maslow's Hierarchy

- Helps in **personal development, education, and workplace motivation.**
- Employers can motivate employees by ensuring:
 - Basic salary (physiological)
 - Job security (safety)
 - Team bonding (belongingness)
 - Recognition (esteem)
 - Growth opportunities (self-actualization)

5. Comparison of Motivation Theories

Theory	Key Idea	Motivation Source	Example
Instinct Theory	Behavior is innate	Biological instincts	Babies cry when hungry
Drive-Reduction	Behavior reduces internal tension	Biological drives	Drinking when thirsty
Arousal Theory	Seek optimal arousal level	Internal arousal	Doing sports for excitement
Maslow's Hierarchy	Needs must be met in order	Hierarchy of needs	Studying → Self-growth

6. Modern Understanding of Motivation

- **Cognitive factors:** Expectations, goals, and beliefs influence motivation.
- **Social factors:** Family, peers, and culture shape what we value and pursue.
- **Emotional link:** Positive emotions (joy, excitement) increase motivation, while negative emotions (fear, anxiety) may reduce it.



7. Connection Between Emotion and Motivation

- Emotions and motivation are **deeply linked**:
 - Emotions **trigger** motivation (fear motivates escape; love motivates care).
 - Motivation **influences** emotions (achieving goals brings joy).
 - Both involve:
 - Biological activation (nervous system)
 - Cognitive interpretation
 - Behavioral response
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8. Key Takeaways

- **Emotion** = Body + Mind reaction to meaningful events.
 - **Mood** = Longer emotional state.
 - **Emotions** help in adaptation, communication, and learning.
 - **Motivation** is the internal energy that drives goal-oriented behavior.
 - **Homeostasis** and **arousal levels** maintain internal balance.
 - **Maslow's hierarchy** organizes needs from basic to self-fulfillment.
 - Both emotion and motivation are **interconnected** processes that shape human behavior and personality.
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